
Introduction to Polymer Materials

Spring, 2022

SUN Dazhi

Syllabus

- **Reference Books**

Polymer Science and Technology Joel R. Fried

- **Lectures**

- TA: 赵静

- **Related labs in** <<材料学综合实验>>

- QQ group

Syllabus

- **Grading**

Homework: 20%

Term paper: 20%

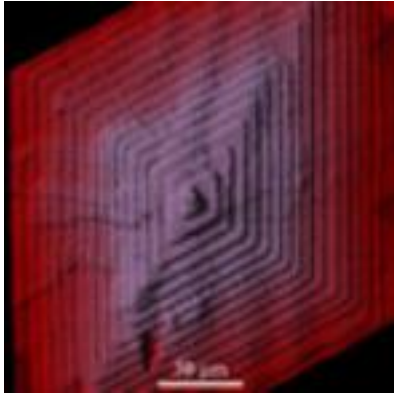
Midterm exam: 20%

Final exam: 40%

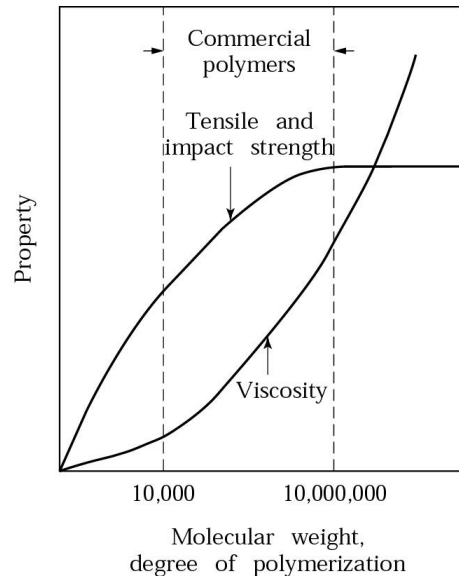
Additional score: 3%

- maximum 2 talks before each class

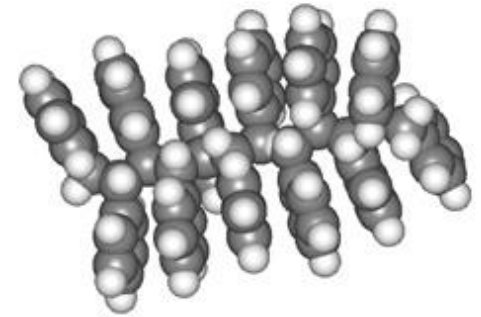
Materials Science of Polymers for Engineers



Physics



Properties



Chemistry



Applications



Processing

Major Functions of Polymers

Adhesives

superglue
epoxies *polyethylene*
polyesters

Barriers

Polyethylene landfill
Garbage bags
Sarah wrap

Structural components

PPMA or PC
transparent sheets
Molded ABS or HIPS

Insulation

Polyurethane foam
Styrofoam
Polyethylene wire coatings
Bakelite (phenol-formaldehyde)

Goals

Learn:

- Basic polymer nomenclature and structure
- Basic types of polymers and how they are made
- Properties of polymers
- Solution properties
- Polymer processing
- Aging & degradation of polymers
- Applications of polymers
- Understand where polymers should be used and what their limitations are.
- Frontier in polymers
- *How to communicate*
- *How to think skeptically*

How to succeed

- Read the Chapter ahead of lectures
- Come to class
- Start paper early
- Study groups
- Prepare exams
- Don't cheat, plagiarize, or otherwise participate in un-ethical behavior
- Learn with Internet: Wikipedia, google(baidu)...
- Ask questions
- Think skeptically

Thinking skeptically

- Don't trust anyone
- If it doesn't make sense, *ask questions*.
- Beware of trusting experts, textbooks, and online information.
- Acquaint yourself with logic and logical fallacies

Term Paper

- *Review of literature topic*
- *Petition* to present topic relating to research
- JACS style bibliography, ≥ 5 pages
- electronic copy
- Literature review on any topics related to polymers
- **Make a video to introduce your topics (mid-term?)**
- One draft due during semester

Introduction to Polymer Materials

Lecture 1: Introduction

SUN Dazhi

Polymers are everywhere



PVC

Food
Packaging

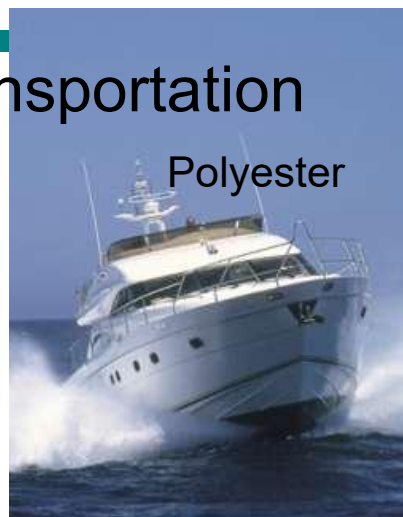


PSSty

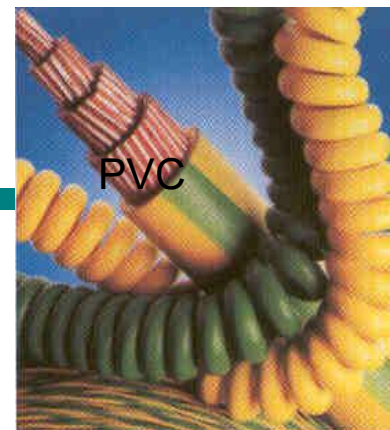
Transportation



Polyisoprene

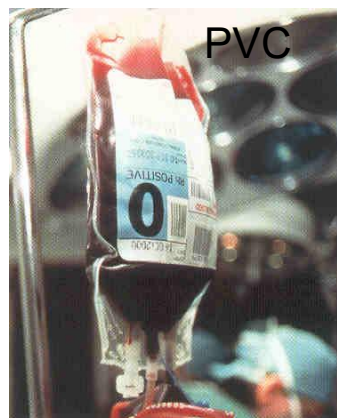


Polyester



PVC

Electronics



PVC

Medical
Supplies

Clothing



Nylon



PP

Construction



SAN

Manufactured
Goods



PC

We use a lot of polymers

Polymer Resins: Millions of pounds '95

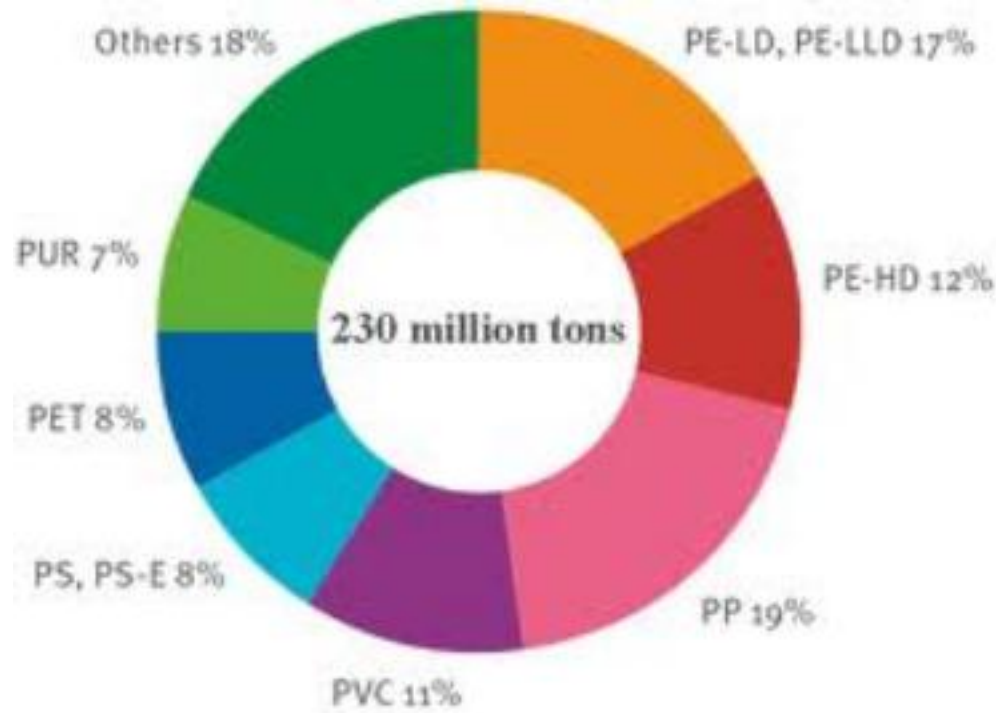
10^{12} bags/year!!

COMMODITY RESINS (CR)		ENGINEERING THERMOPLASTICS	
LDPE	7,500	PC	760
LLDPE	6,000	ACETALS	330
HDPE	11,600	PAI	
EVA	1,200	ARYLATES	
PP	10,600	PEEK	
PVC	11,800	PEI	
ACRYLICS	550	PI	
PS	6,000	PPO	
ABS	1,500	PPS	
PET	4,000	SULPHONE	
POLYESTER	1,600	LCP	
NYLON	1,000		
Total	63,350		

> 50% of CR crystallizable POs.
~70% of total CR crystallizable.



We use a lot of polymers

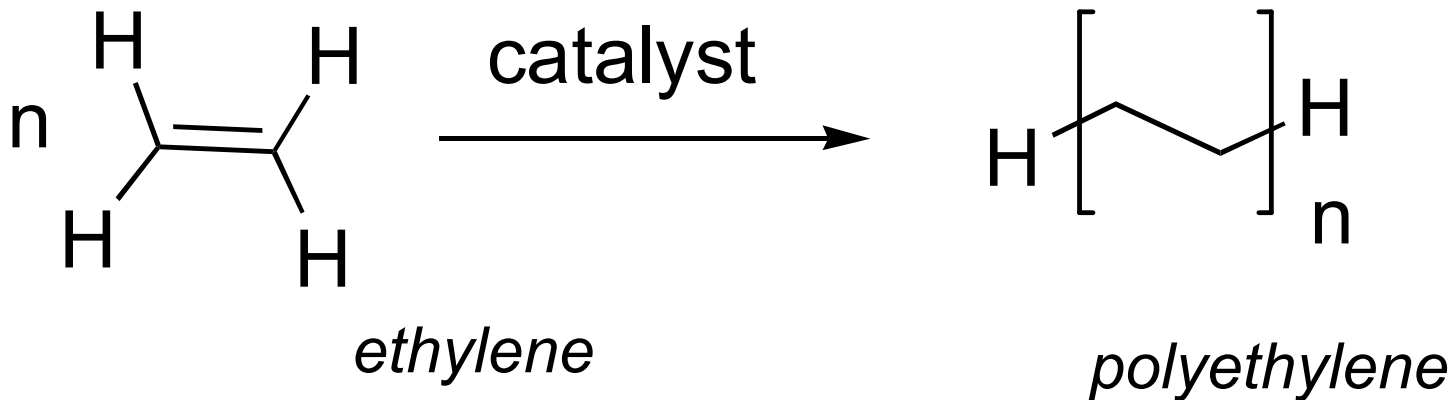


World wide consumption of plastics in 2009
~9% increase annually

What are polymers?

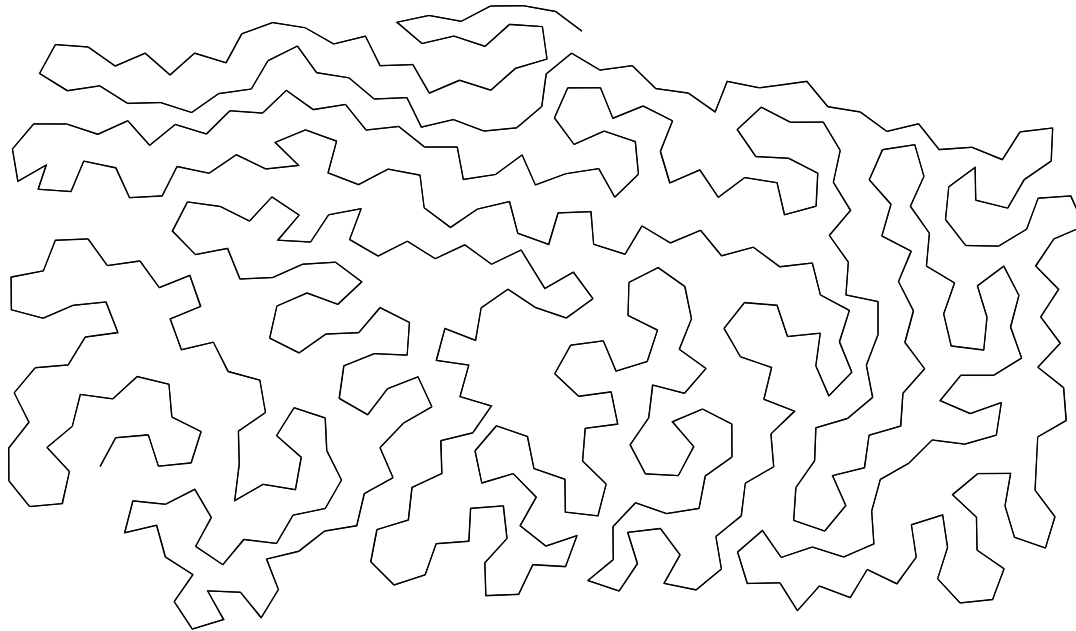
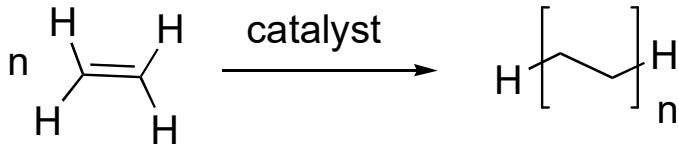
Poly = many & meros = parts (Greek)

Macromolecules = large molecules



A nomenclature exists to describe polymers

What are polymers?

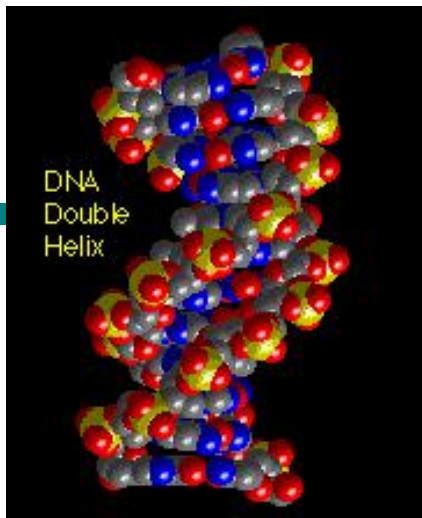


Chemical Formula: $\text{C}_{500}\text{H}_{1002}$
Molecular Weight: 7015.31
Elemental Analysis: C, 85.60; H, 14.40

Contour length: 38.5 nm or 0.0385 microns or 0.0000385 mm

10^6 Dalton polyethylene (35.7K monomers) = 5.5 microns or 0.0055 mm in length

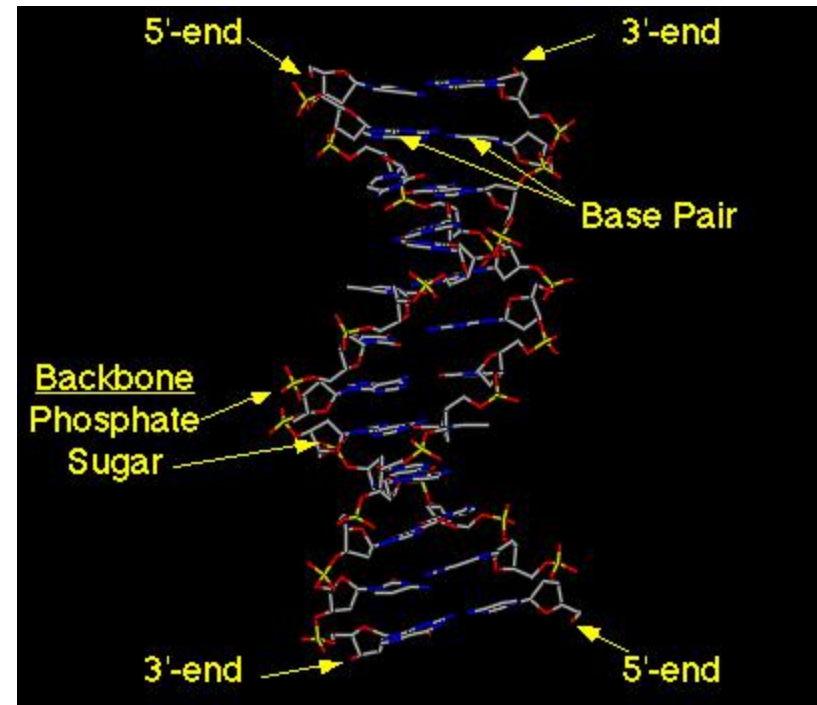
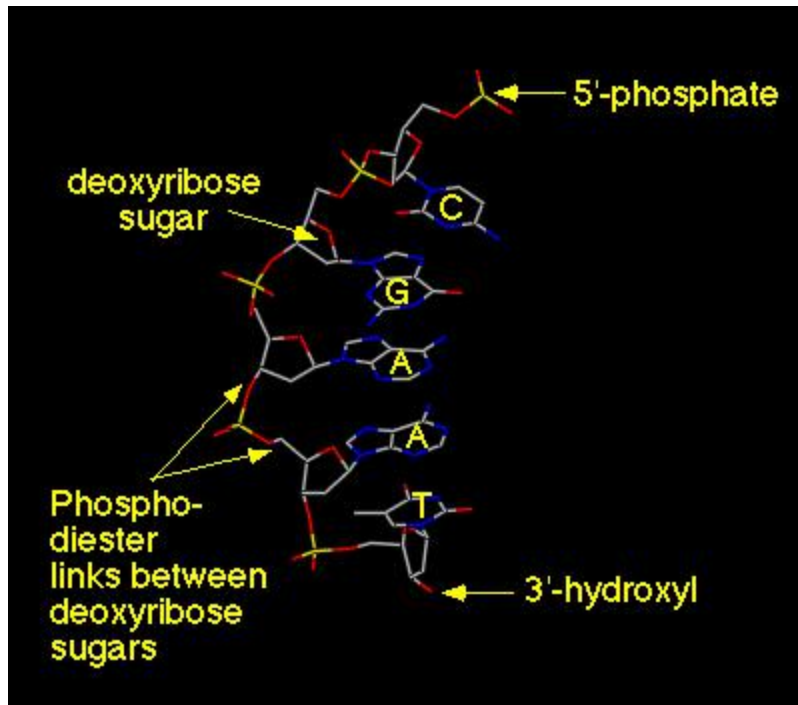
Length of DNA



Each DNA polymer = 5 centimeters

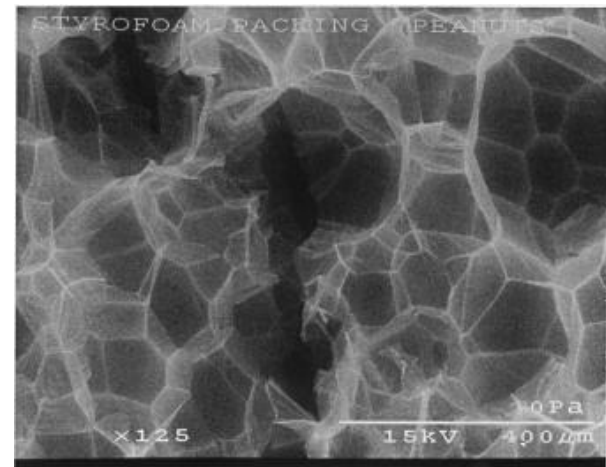
DNA (3 billion base pairs) = 2.3 meters long/cell

Total length of DNA in a human: 2×10^{13} meters



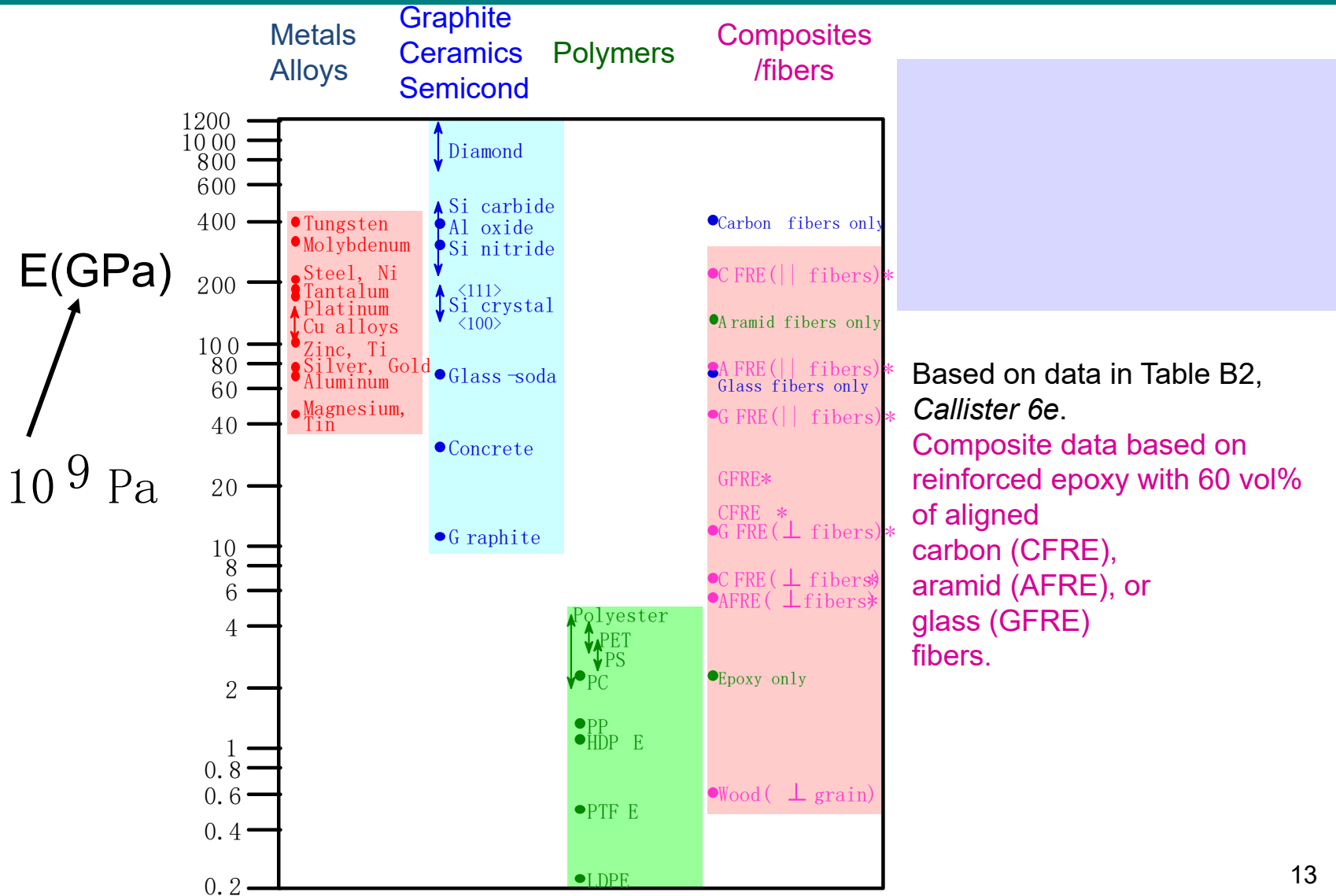
Engineering with Polymers

- Polymers provide a low density structural alternative for some applications
- Are relatively easy to process into numerous forms
- Provide a high volume, often improved replacement for materials derived from living organisms.
- Possess unique properties
- They are often relatively inexpensive.

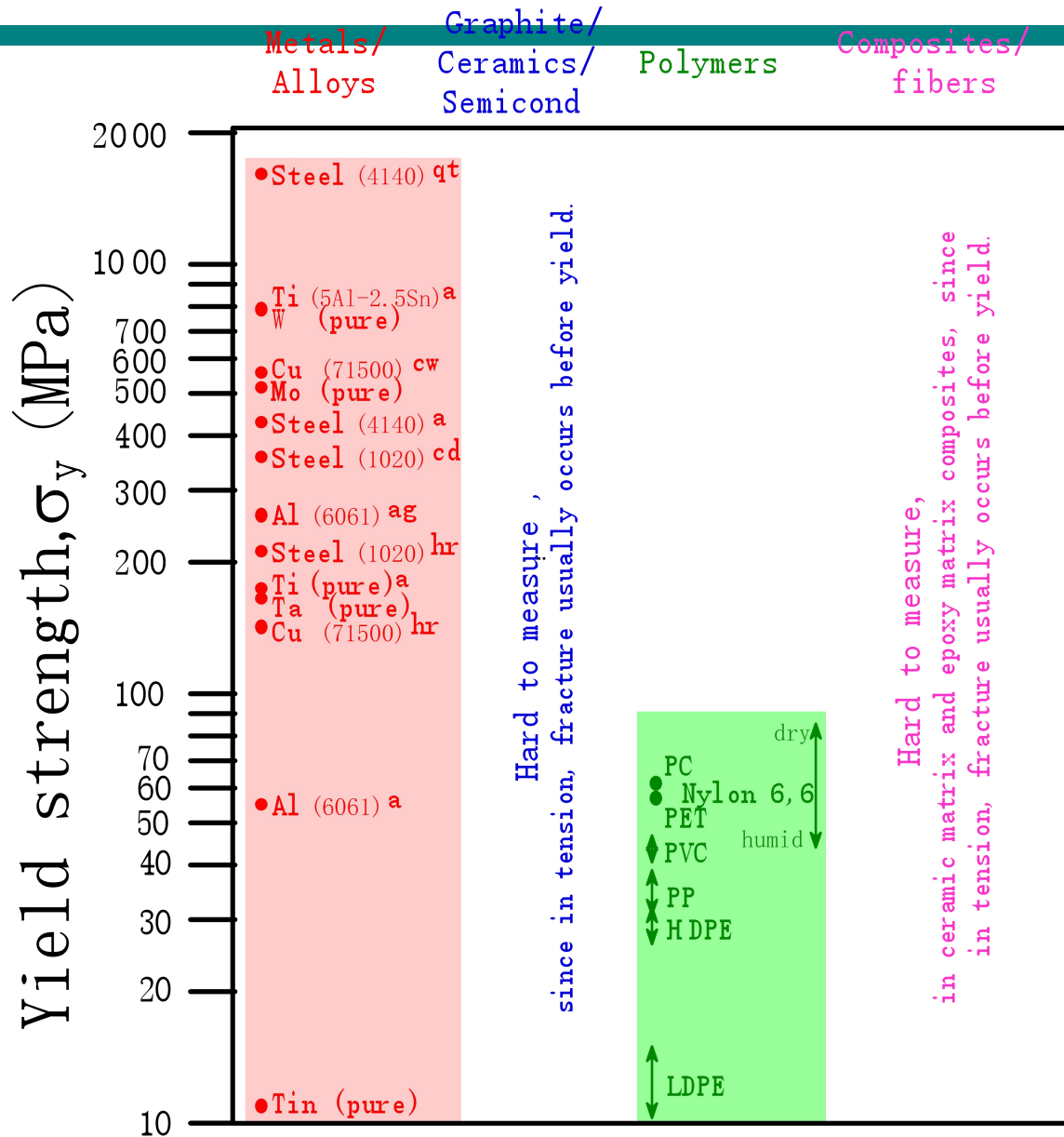


Styrofoam ®

YOUNG'S MODULI: COMPARISON



YIELD STRENGTH: COMPARISON



σ_y (ceramics)

>> σ_y (metals)

>> σ_y (polymers)

Room T values

Based on data in Table B4, *Callister 6e*.

a = annealed

hr = hot rolled

ag = aged

cd = cold drawn

cw = cold worked

qt = quenched & tempered

Why use polymers

- Easy to process
 - Injection molding (thermoplastics)
 - Mold or reaction injection molding (thermosets)
- Cheap
- Lightweight
- Tough
- Flexible
- Transparent (sometimes)
- Insulating (generally)

How do we classify polymers?

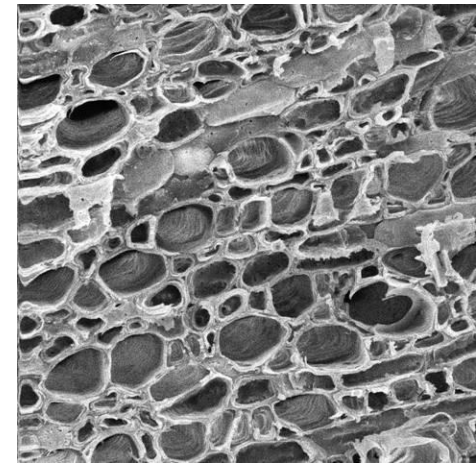
- By origin
- Physical behavior
- Structure/Architecture
- Application/function
- Polymerization mechanism
- Polymerization chemistry
- Cost

Origin of Polymers



Biopolymers

- Protein: horn, cartilage, hair, hide, ligaments, tusks
- Composite structures: bone, shells
- Plant materials:
 - Cellulose (cotton, sisal, hemp) fiber
 - lignin & cellulose (wood)
 - Chitan (insect & crustacean exoskeletons)



Synthetic Polymers

Coal

Petroleum

Natural gas

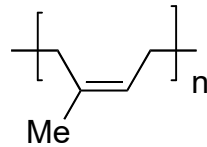
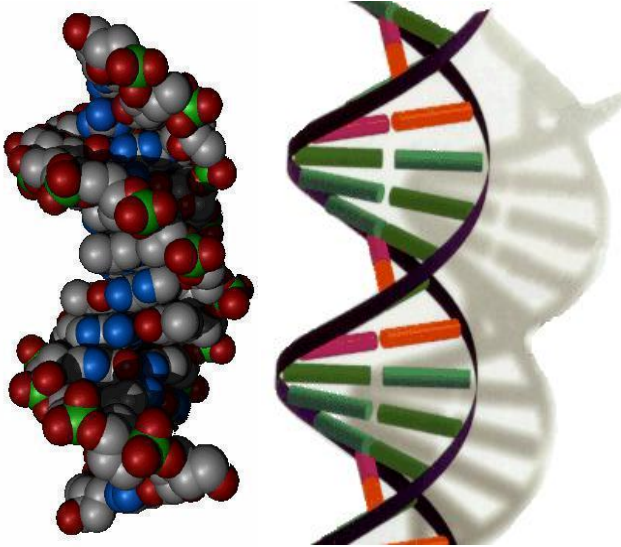


Petroleum from *petra* oleum (rock oil)

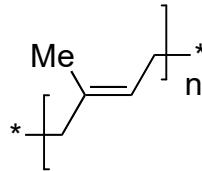


Origins: Two Families of Polymers

Biological Polymers

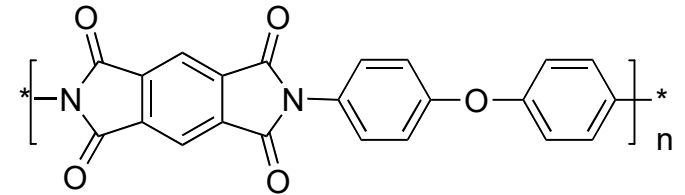


latex rubber

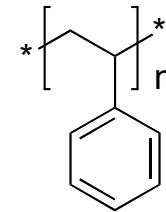


gutta percha

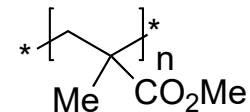
Synthetic



polyimide (PI)



polystyrene



polymethylmethacrylate (PMMA)

Physical Behavior & Architecture

- Thermoplastics

Polystyrene
Polyvinylchloride

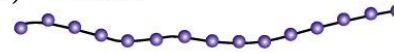
- Elastomers

Synthetic rubbers
Poly-cis-isoprene

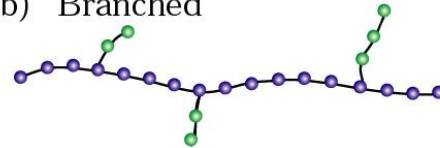
- Thermosets

Phenolic Resins
Melamines
epoxies

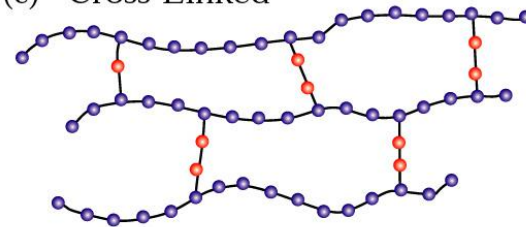
(a) Linear



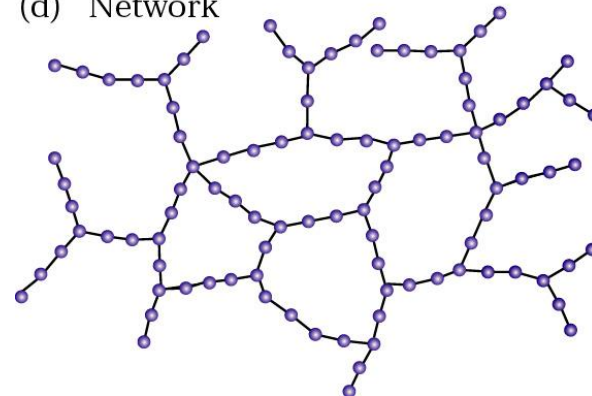
(b) Branched



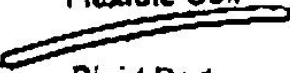
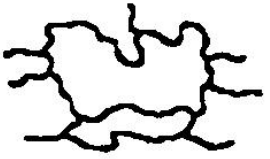
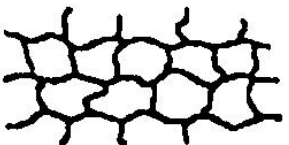
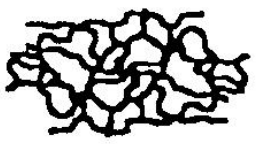
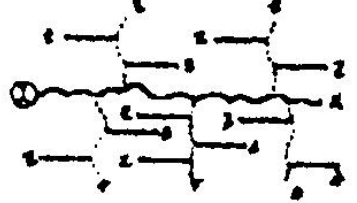
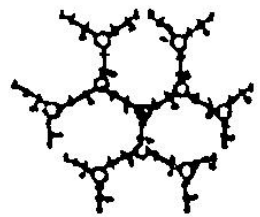
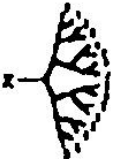
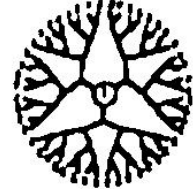
(c) Cross-Linked



(d) Network



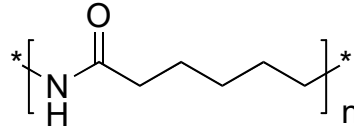
Major Macromolecular Architectures

I	II	III	IV
Linear	Cross-Linked	Branched	Dendritic
 Flexible Coil  Rigid Rod  Cyclic (Closed Linear)  Polyrotaxane  Ladder	 Lightly Cross-Linked  Densely Cross-Linked  Interpenetrating Networks  2-D Lightly Cross-Linked	 Random Short Branches  Random Long Branches  Regular Comb-Branched  Regular Star-Branched	(a)  Random Hyperbranched (b)  Dendrigrafts II.  Dendrigrafts (c)   Dendrons Dendrimers
1930's -	1940's -	1960's -	1980's -

Source: R. Esfand, D.A. Tomalia, A.E. Beezer, J.C. Mitchell, M. Hardy, C. Orford, Polymer Preprints, **41** (2), 1324 (2000)

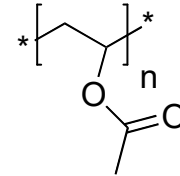
Applications/Function

- Structural



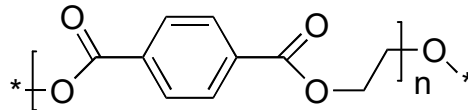
Nylon-6

- Coatings



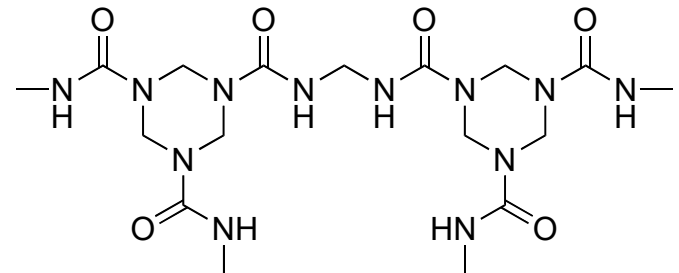
Poly(vinyl acetate) or PVA

- Fibers



Poly(ethylene terephthalate) or PETE

- Adhesives



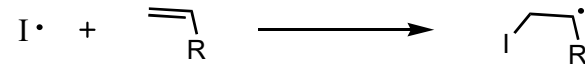
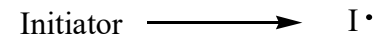
Urea-Formaldehyde

Taxonomy by polymerization mechanism

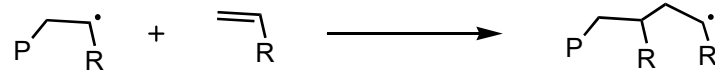
Chain Growth Mechanism

- Free radical
- Anionic
- Cationic
- Ring opening

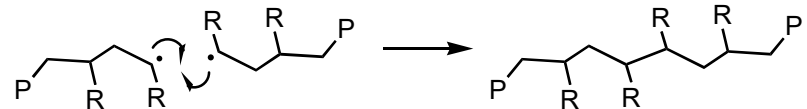
Initiation



Propagation



Termination



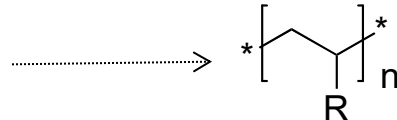
Step growth

- Condensation
- Metathesis

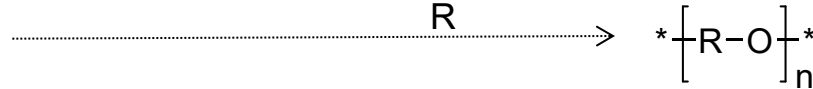
Free radical chain mechanism

Polymer Functionality

Vinyl Polymers



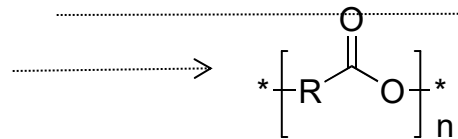
Polyethers



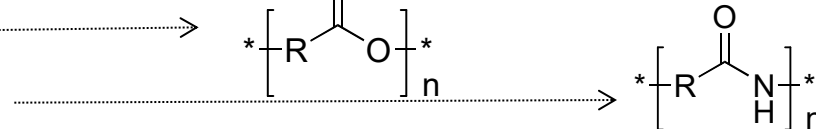
Polyarylenes



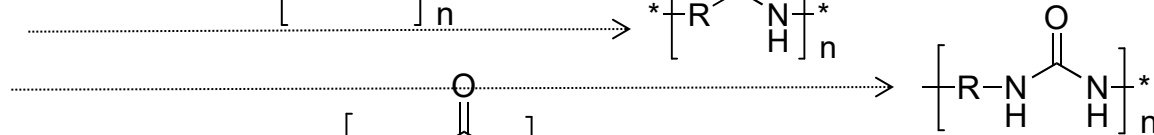
Polyesters



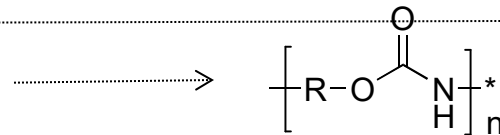
Polyamides



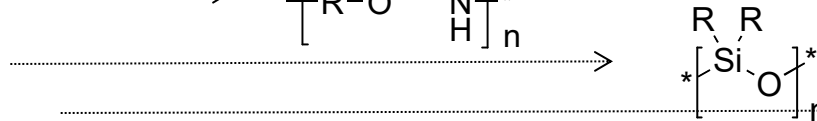
Polyureas



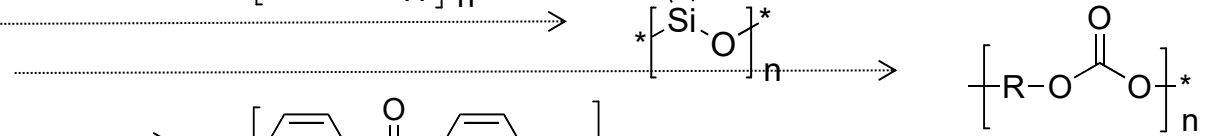
Polyurethanes



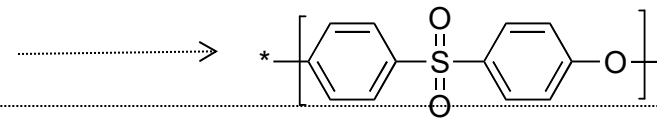
Polysiloxanes



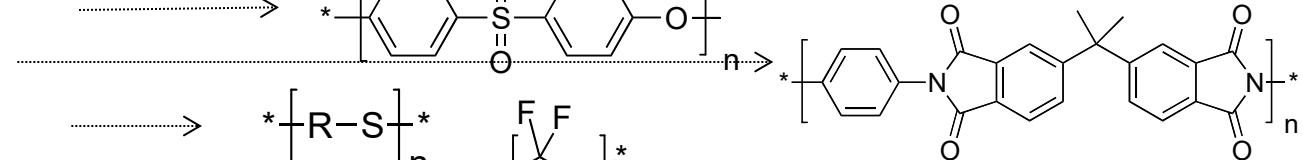
Polycarbonates



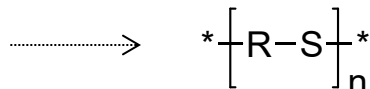
Polysulfones



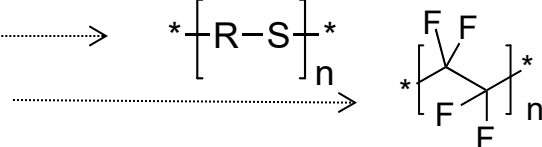
Polyimides



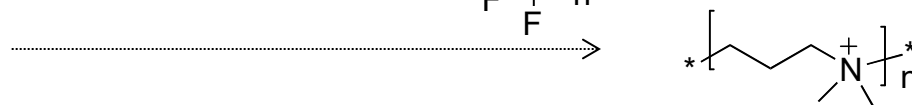
Polysulfides



Fluoropolymers



Polyionomers



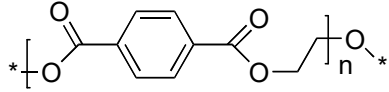
Polyacetylenes



Recycling symbols



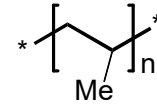
PETE



Poly(ethylene terephthalate) or PETE



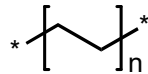
PP



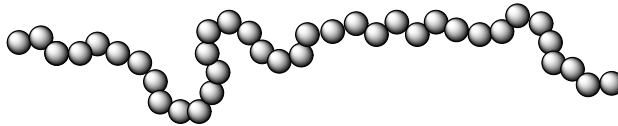
poly(propylene)



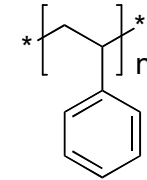
HDPE



high density polyethylene



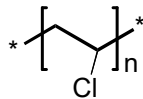
PS



polystyrene



V



polyvinyl chloride

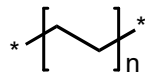


Other

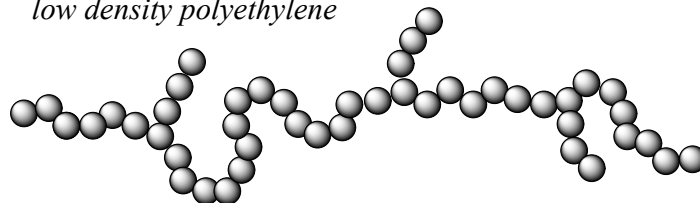
Not recyclable



LDPE

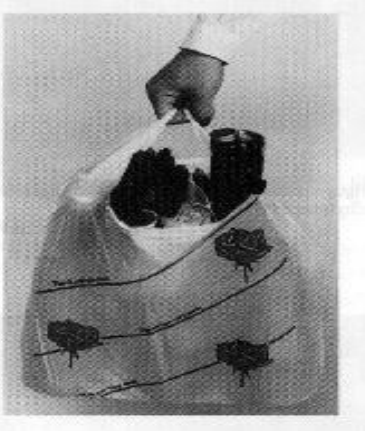


low density polyethylene



Cost: Commodity (Amorphous) Thermoplastics

- Four high volume thermoplastics and applications:
 - Polyethylene (PE): Grocery bag, 55-gallon drum, lawn furniture
 - Polypropylene (PP): Washing machine agitator, carpet
 - Polyvinylchloride (PVC): Irrigation pipe, wire insulation
 - Polystyrene (PS): Toys, pipes, packing material (Styrofoam)



Polyethylene



Polypropylene



Polystyrene



Polyvinylchloride

- Low cost, temp. resistance and strength • Good dimensional stability
- Bonds well • Typically, but not always, transparent

Some History: First there were Bio-Polymers

Animal Hides (Proteins): Fiber & Films

Ligaments (Collagen): Hinges

Silk Fibers (Protein): Fibers

Plant Fibers (Cellulose): Fibers



Yucca-fiber sandals



Bison-Hide teepee

Structural Materials: High Modulus & Strong

Wood (Cellulose & Lignin): S

Antlers (Keratin): Tools, jewelry & weapons

Horn (Keratin): Tools, jewelry & weapons

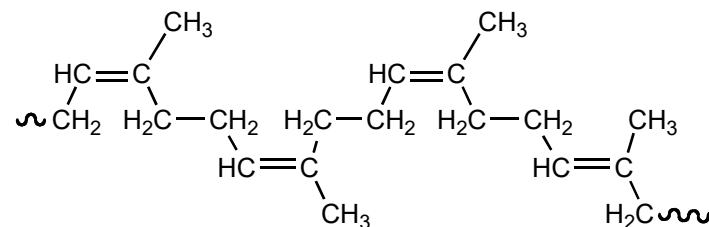
Tusks (enamel & dentin): Tools, jewelry & weapons



Ivory lunar cycle charts

Key Figures in Polymer History:

Invented vulcanization of rubber in 1839



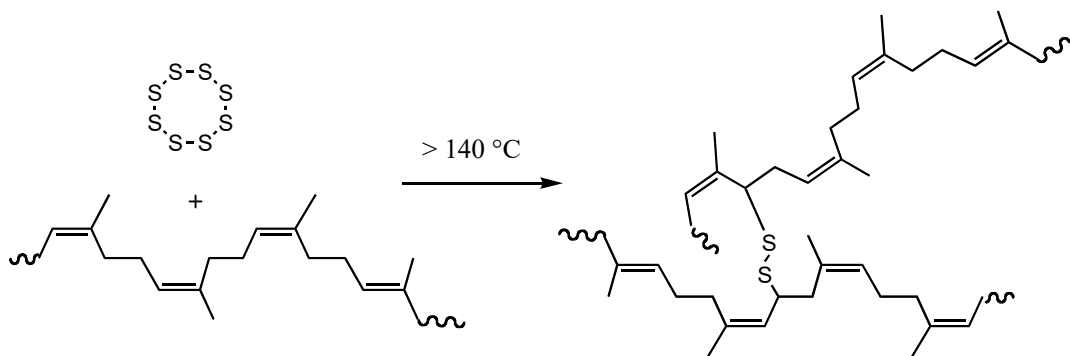
Poly-*cis*-isoprene

IUPAC: *cis*-poly(1-methyl-1-butene-1,4-diyl)

Elastomer:

50% of Rubber tires

Latex rubber gloves



Charles Goodyear (1800 - 1860)

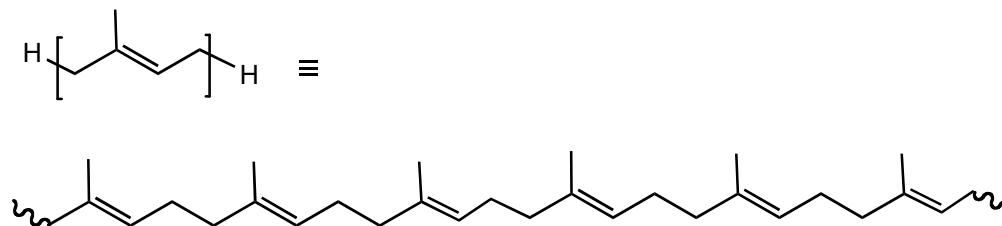
Enabled commercialization of natural rubber

Gutta Percha



William Montgomery (1840's)

*Saw usefulness
of gutta percha*



trans-Polyisoprene or Gutta percha

IUPAC: *trans*-poly(1-methyl-1-butene-1,4-diyl)

Thermoplastic:

Golf ball covers

Wire coating (until 1940's)



Gutta percha (GP), also known as balata, is a natural thermoplastic and is of fundamental importance in the history of the plastics industry.

History of Polymers

Date	Material	Example Use
1868	Cellulose Nitrate	Figurines
1909	Phenol-Formaldehyde	Electrical equipment
1919	Cellulose Acetate	Celluloid

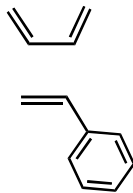
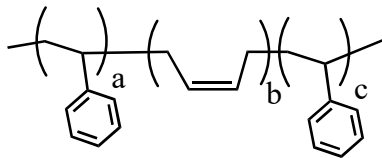
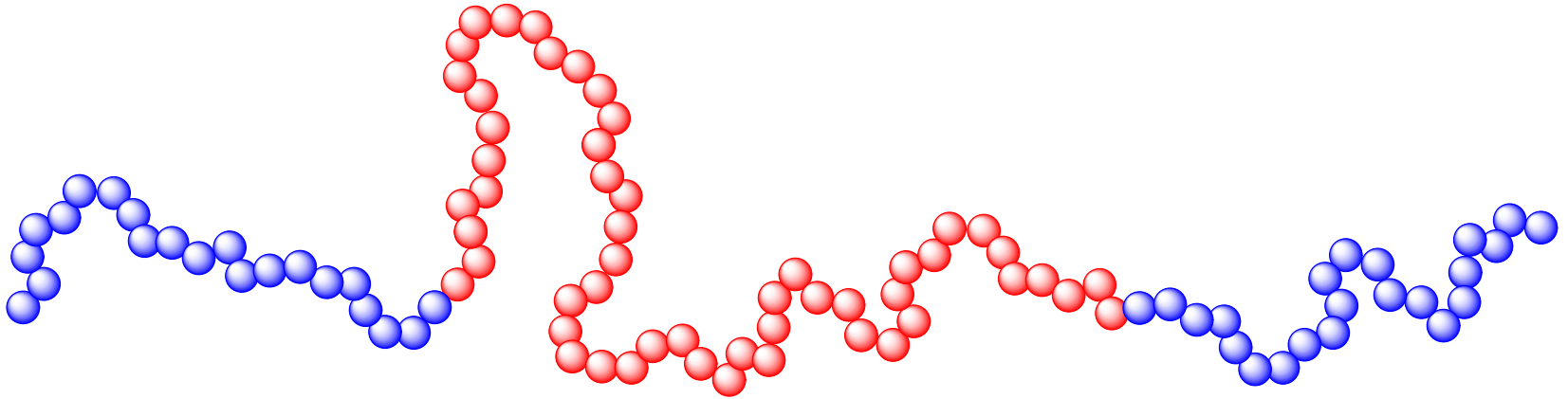


History of Polymers

Date	Material	Example Use
1942	Polyester	Clothing, Boat hulls
1942	Polyethylene	Plastic bags
1943	Teflon	Pots, Non-stick liners
1943	Acrylic	Nails
1947	Styrene	Styrofoam
1948	Neoprene	Wetsuits
1954	Polyurethane	Shoel heels
1956	Polypropylene	Plastic bottles
1957	Polyethylene Glycol	Medical devices
1957	Polyethylene Glycol	Medical devices



Block Copolymers

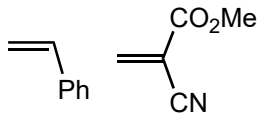
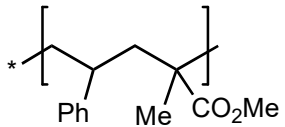
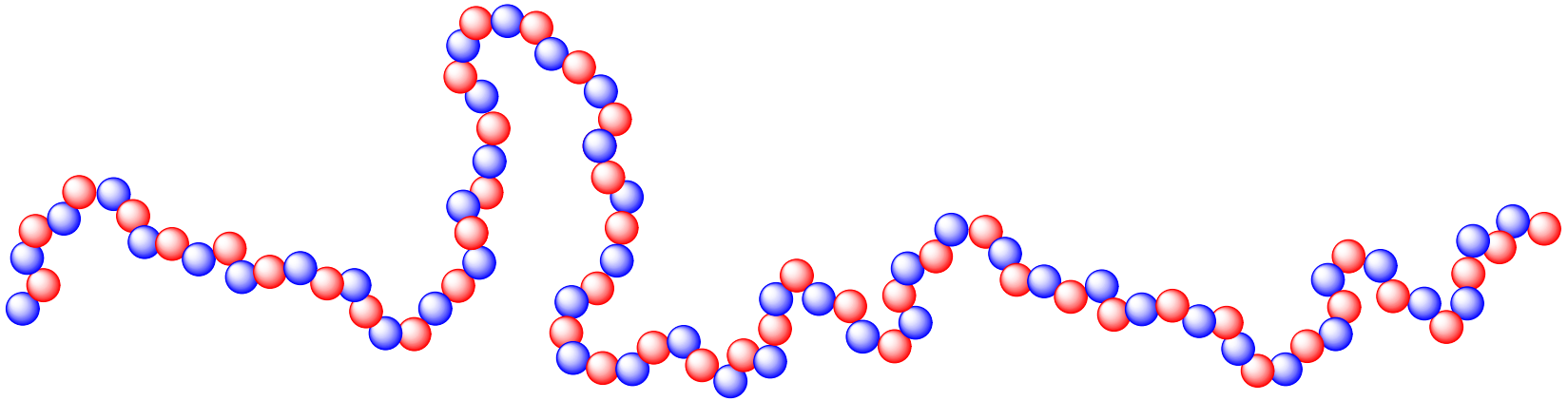


Polystyrene-block-poly-1,4-butadiene-block-polystyrene

Block-copolymer[styrene-butadiene-styrene]

SBS

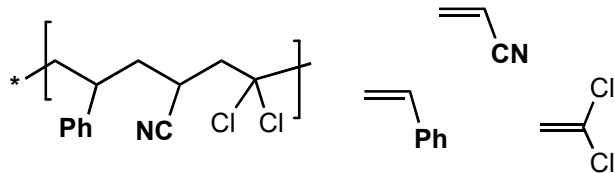
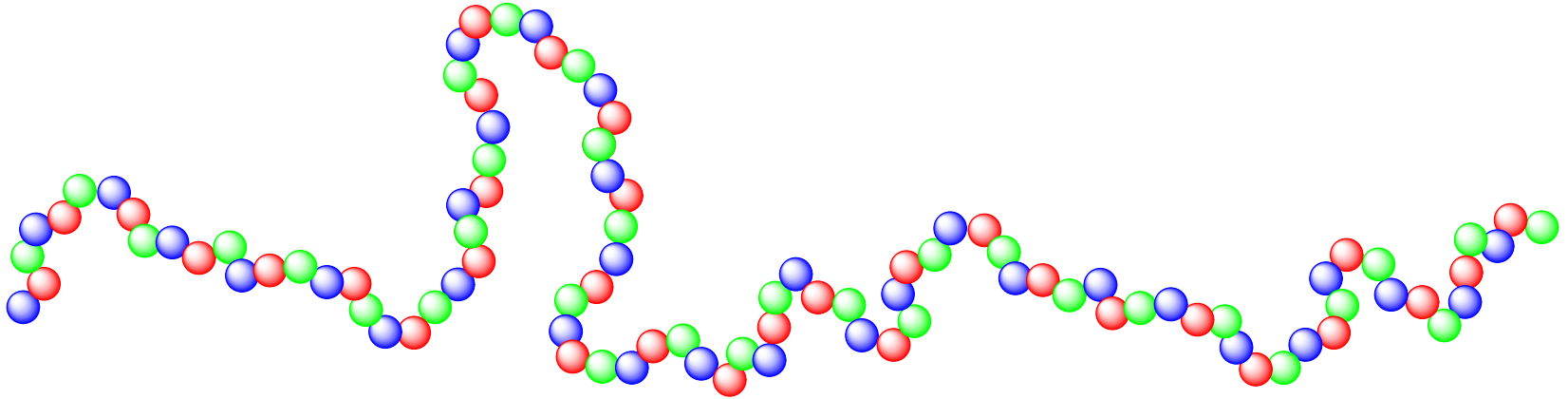
Alternating Copolymers



Poly[styrene-alt-(methyl methacrylate)]

Alt-copoly[styrene/methyl methacrylate]

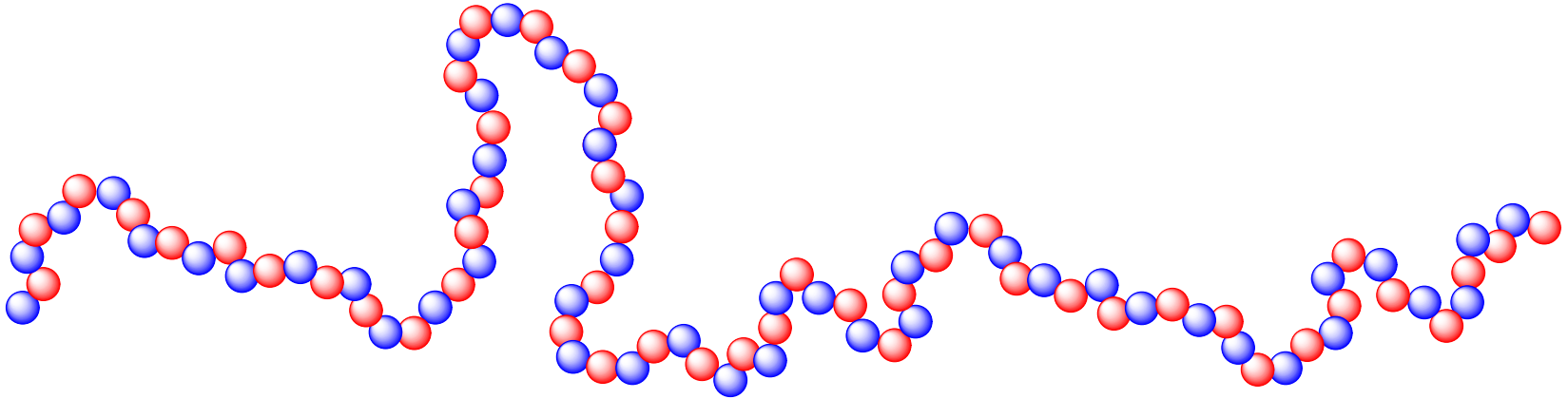
Alternating Copolymers



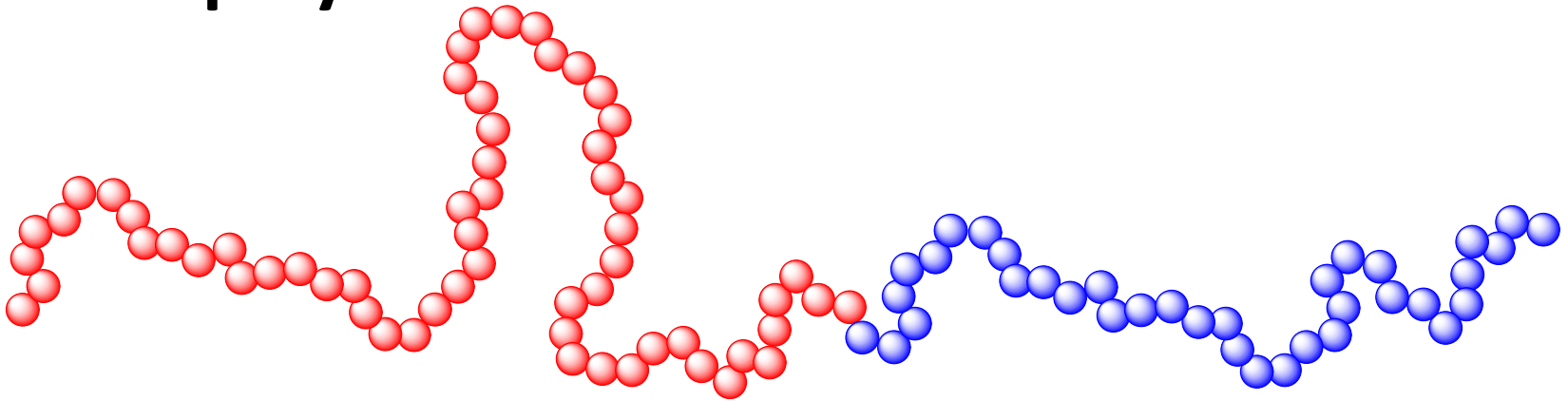
Poly[styrene-alt-(acrylonitrile)-alt-(vinylidene dichloride)]

Alt-copoly[styrene/acrylonitrile/vinylidene dichloride]

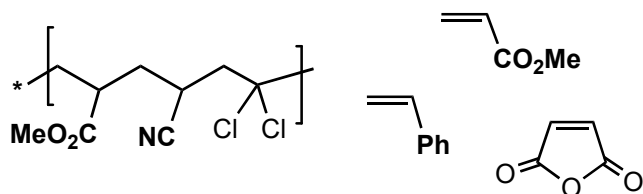
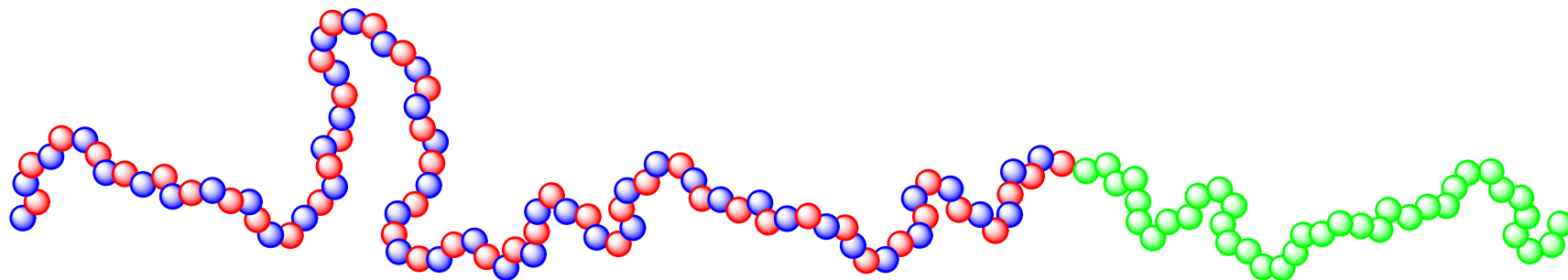
Alternating Copolymers



Block Copolymers



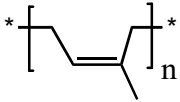
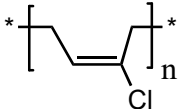
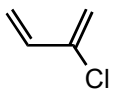
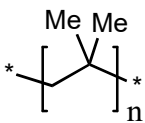
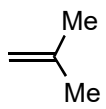
Block & Alternating Copolymer



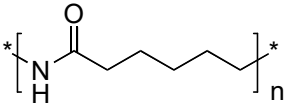
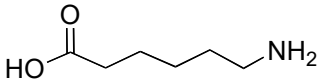
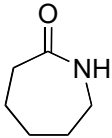
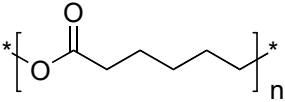
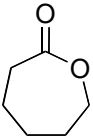
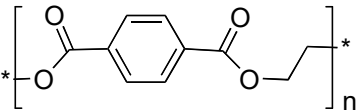
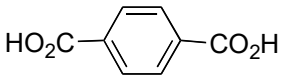
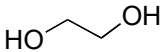
Poly[methyl acrylate-block-(poly(maleic anhydride)-alt-styrene)]

Block-copoly[alt-co(styrene/maleic anhydride)methyl acrylate]

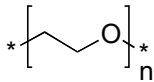
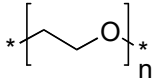
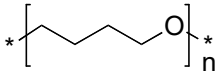
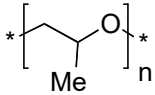
Nomenclature of Elastomers

Structure	Monomer	Common Name	IUPAC	Trade name
		<i>cis</i> -Polyisoprene	<i>cis</i> -poly(1-methyl-1-butene-1,4-diyl)	latex
		Polychloroprene	poly(1-chloro-1-butene-1,4-diyl)	Neoprene
		Polyisobutylene	poly(1,1-dimethyl-ethene-1,2-diyl)	Butyl Rubber

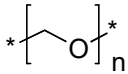
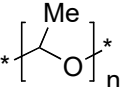
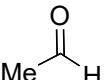
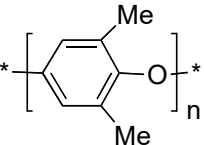
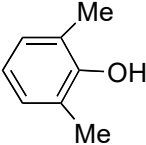
Nomenclature of Thermoplastics

Structure	Monomer	Common Name	IUPAC	Trade name
	 6-aminohexanoic acid	poly(6-hexanamide)	poly(imino(1-oxohexamethylene))	Nylon-6
	 azepan-2-one or caprolactam	polycaprolactam		
		polycaprolactone	poly(oxy(1-oxohexamethylene))	
	 	poly(ethylene terephthalate)	Poly(oxyethylene-oxyterephthaloyl)	PETE

Nomenclature of Polyether Thermoplastics

Structure	Monomer	Common Name	IUPAC
	 ethylene oxide or oxirane	polyethyleneoxide	polyoxyethylene
	HO-CH ₂ -CH ₂ -OH ethylene glycol	poly(ethylene glycol)	polyoxyethylene PEG
	 tetrahydrofuran	poly(tetrahydrofuran)	poly(oxytetramethylene)
	 propylene oxide	poly(propylene-oxide)	poly(oxy(1-methylethylene))

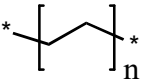
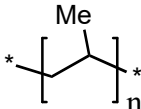
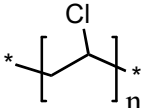
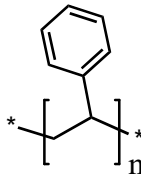
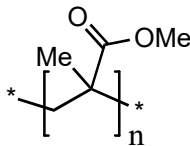
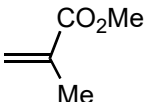
Nomenclature of Polyether Thermoplastics

Structure	Monomer	Common Name	IUPAC	
	 formaldehyde	poly(formaldehyde)	poly(oxymethylene)	
	 acetaldehyde	poly(acetaldehyde)	poly(oxyethylidene)	Delrin
		poly(phenyleneoxide)	poly(oxy-2,6-dimethyl-1,4-phenylene)	



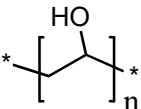
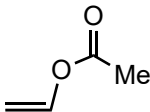
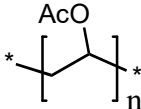
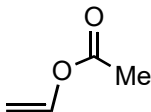
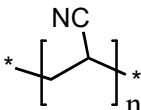
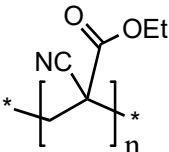
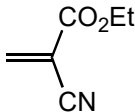
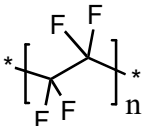
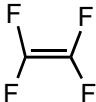
Delrin

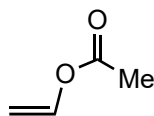
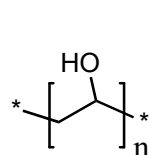
Nomenclature of Vinyl Thermoplastics

Structure	Monomer	Common Name	IUPAC	Trade Name
	$=$	Polyethylene	poly(ethylene)	PE
		Polypropylene	poly(propylene)	PP
		Polyvinyl chloride	poly(1-chloroethylene)	PVC
		Polystyrene	poly(1-phenylethylene)	PS
		Polymethyl methacrylate	poly(1-(methoxycarbonyl)-1-methylethylene)	PMMA



Nomenclature of Vinyl Thermoplastics

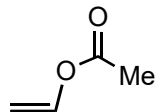
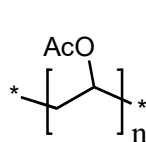
Structure	Monomer	Common Name	IUPAC	Trade Name
		Polyvinyl alcohol	poly(1-hydroxyethylene)	PVA
		Polyvinyl acetate	poly(1-acetoxyethylene)	
		Polyacrylonitrile	poly(1-cyanoethylene)	PAN 
		Poly(ethyl cyanoacrylate)	poly(1-cyano-1-(ethoxy carbonyl)ethylene)	Super glue 
		Poly(tetrafluoroethylene)	Poly(tetrafluoroethylene)	Teflon



Polyvinyl alcohol

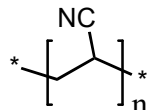
poly(1-hydroxyethylene)

PVA



Polyvinyl acetate

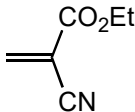
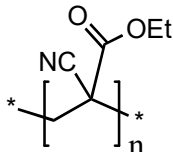
poly(1-acetoxyethylene)



Polyacrylonitrile

poly(1-cyanoethylene)

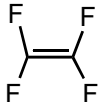
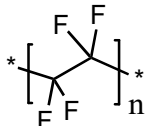
PAN



Poly(ethyl cyanoacrylate)

poly(1-cyano-1-(ethoxy carbonyl)ethylene)

Super glue



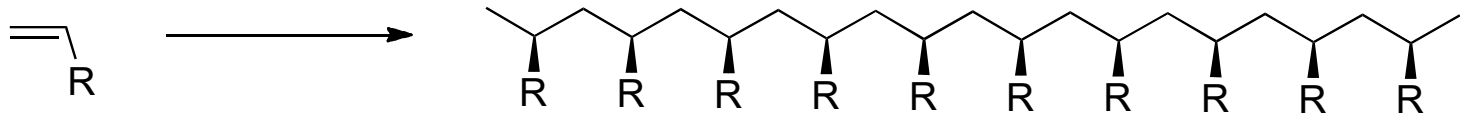
Poly(tetrafluoroethylene)

Poly(tetrafluoroethylene)

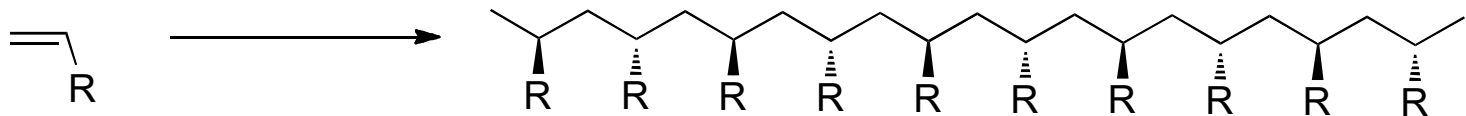
Teflon

Tacticity: How groups are arranged along polymer

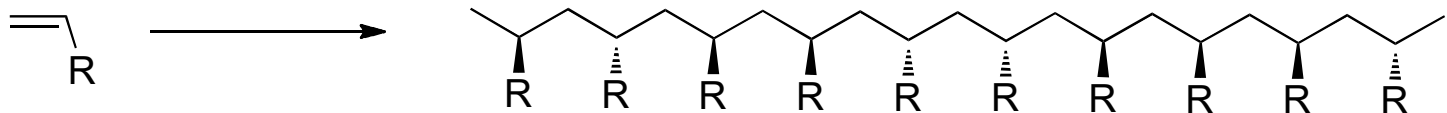
Vinyl Monomers



isotactic



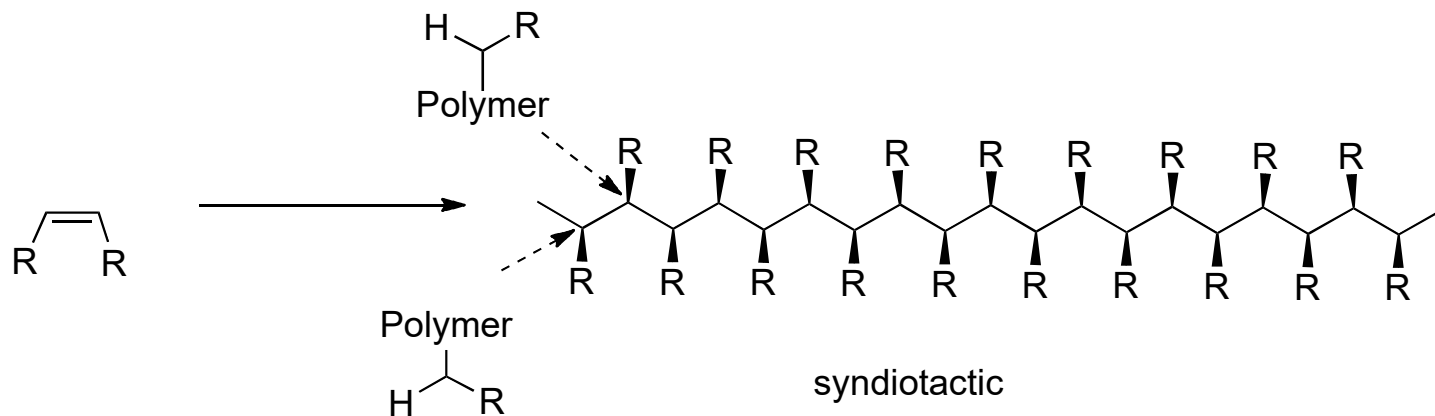
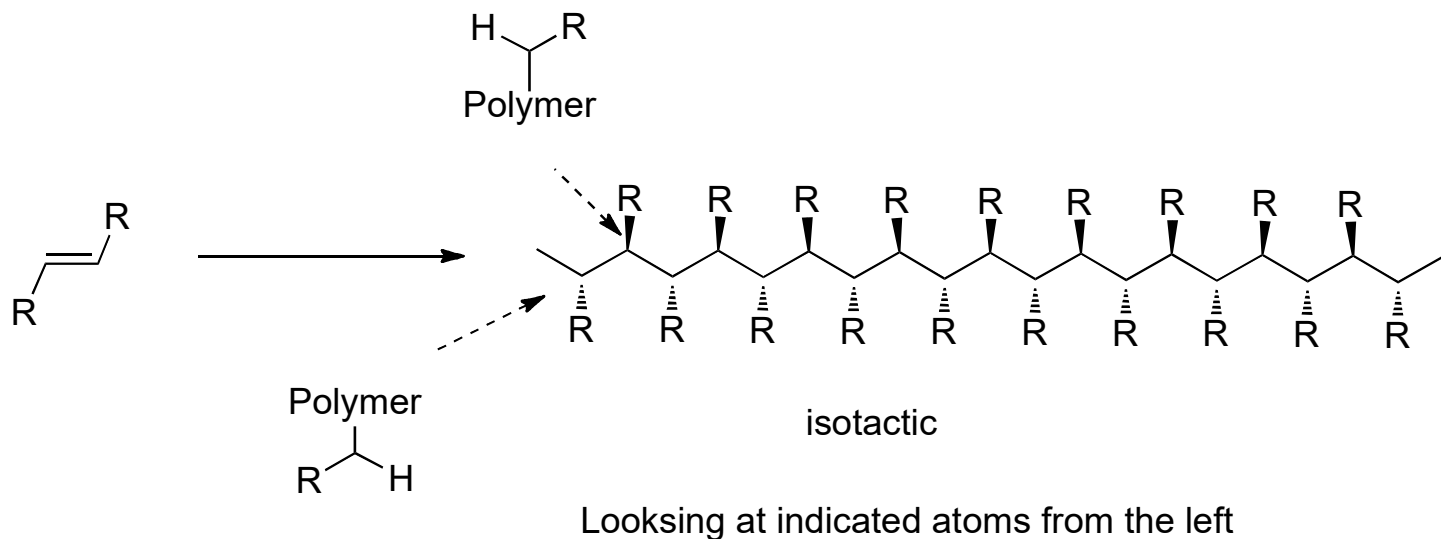
syndiotactic



atactic

Isotactic and syndiotactic pack into lattices easier: crystalline

Tacticity: disubstituted monomers



HOMEWORK

“Polymers in our daily lives”

Write an essay